

Table 6.2.5 : Distribution of Persons Aged 5 Years and Over with Disabilities by Sector and Domain of Disability, 2024

		Sector				
		Total	Urban	Estate Urban	Rural	Estate Rural
Total population aged 5 years and over	Number	20,566,680	3,613,813	11,299	16,131,086	810,482
Population with at least one disability	Number	727,293	96,426	260	601,740	28,867
	Rate (per 1,000 persons)	35	27	23	37	36
Domain of Disability		Total	Urban	Estate Urban	Rural	Estate Rural
Seeing	Number	192,578	23,378	73	159,285	9,842
	Rate (per 1,000 persons)	9	6	6	10	12
Hearing	Number	130,097	14,653	45	110,852	4,547
	Rate (per 1,000 persons)	6	4	4	7	6
Walking or climbing steps	Number	447,969	60,562	146	371,207	16,054
	Rate (per 1,000 persons)	22	17	13	23	20
Remembering or concentrating on something	Number	167,826	23,117	50	138,988	5,671
	Rate (per 1,000 persons)	8	6	4	9	7
Selfcare, such as washing all over or dressing	Number	189,292	28,745	70	153,226	7,251
	Rate (per 1,000 persons)	9	8	6	9	9
Communicating with others	Number	112,798	16,650	44	91,800	4,304
	Rate (per 1,000 persons)	5	5	4	6	5

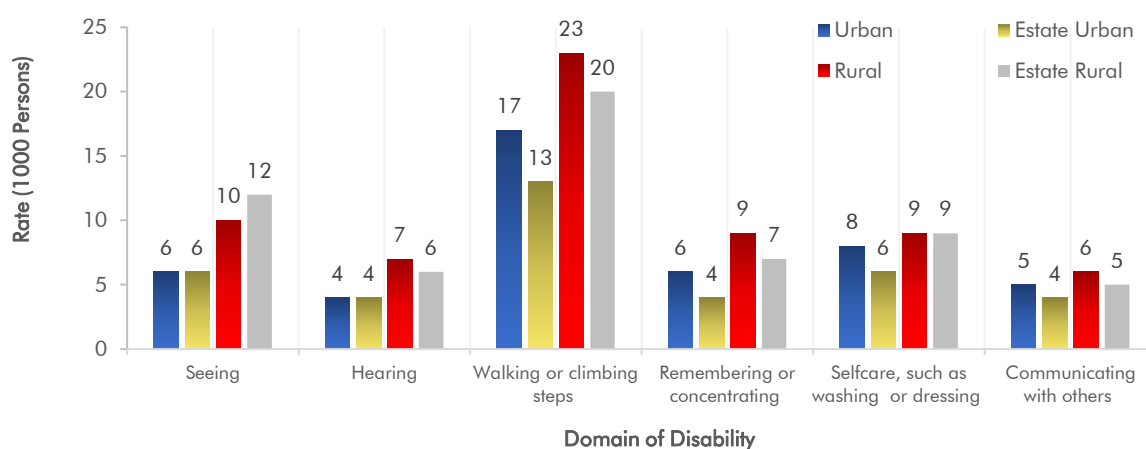


Figure 6.2.2 : Disability Rate (per 1,000 persons) by Sector and Domain of Disability, 2024

As presented in Table 6.2.5, among the four sectors, the rural sector reported the highest number of persons with disabilities for each type of disability. Furthermore, as illustrated in Figure 6.2.2, the rural sector also reported the highest rates of disability in walking or climbing (23 per 1,000 individuals), remembering or concentrating (9 per 1,000 individuals), hearing (7 per 1,000 individuals), and communication (6 per 1,000 individuals). However, with regard to disability in seeing the highest rate was observed in the estate rural sector, where 12 persons per 1,000 population were reported to have a seeing disability.

As given in Table 6.2.6 the highest number of persons with at least one disability (75,118) was reported in Gampaha district. However, the highest disability rate was observed in the Kurunegala district, where 43 persons per 1,000 population. The lowest rate of disability was reported from Colombo district, corresponding to 25 persons per 1,000 population.